Swahili civilization

The Swahili civilization was located on the east African coast and existed for more than a hundred years. This culture originated when some locals mixed with foreign traders who were mostly known to be Arabs. Consequently, the culture and language that emerged was in a mixed form called Swahili. The term means ‘people of the coast’ in Arabic because the Swahili people lived in coastal towns. This location was easy to trade with Arabs and others who travelled long distances from different parts of the world. Each coastal town was independent of others and differentiated itself from the Nubians and the Ancient Egyptians. Therefore, the Swahilis did not have a single kingdom or their own. Their towns consisted of stonewall buildings similar to those of the Arabs. However, the buildings further inland were a mixture of African and Arabic styles. The people from the Swahili civilization adopted the Islamic religion several centuries after it began in the 7^{th} century.